

PULSEGUARD TECHNOLOGIES INC. - STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

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Title:	PRODUCTION DATA ACCESS AND PRIVACY PROTOCOLS
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Department:	Data & Analytics
Author:	Sanjay Mehta (Chief Data Officer)
Approver:	Sneha Deshmukh (VP of Engineering / Data Committee)
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1. PURPOSE & OBJECTIVE

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the mandatory access request procedures, anonymization guidelines, and data governance policies for sensitive production databases and Customer Personally Identifiable Information (PII) at PulseGuard. The goal is to enforce strict compliance with data privacy regulations (GDPR, CCPA) and prevent unauthorized access or data leaks.

2. SCOPE

This procedure applies to all direct database access requests, analytical queries, reporting extracts, dashboard configurations, and data exports involving customer records owned, managed, or stored by PulseGuard Technologies Inc. It governs all data analysts, database administrators, and developers.

3. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

3.1. Data Custodian (Database Administrator)

- Manages database permissions and RLS configurations.
- Wipes and anonymizes staging database exports.
- Performs quarterly database access reviews.

3.2. Data Analyst / Developer

- Submits data access tickets with formal business justification.
- Employs data masking/anonymization before sharing datasets.

3.3. Chief Data Officer (CDO)

- Approves access requests for production financial or customer database logs.
- Reviews data audit logs monthly.

4. DEFINITIONS AND REFERENCES

- Personally Identifiable Information (PII): Any data that can identify a specific individual (e.g. names, emails, phone numbers, passport numbers).
- Row-Level Security (RLS): A database security feature that restricts database rows based on the department or profile of the user executing the query.
- IT Ticketing System: The official company ticket portal (Jira Access Management).
- SOP-DATA-002: Data Backup and Retention Policy (reference document).

5. DATA ACCESS REQUEST AND APPROVAL RULES

Any employee requesting database access must conform to the following mandates:

5.1. Logged Requests Required

- All requests for direct database access must be logged via the IT Ticketing System.
- Verbal, text message, or email approvals are strictly invalid. Operating without a ticket is a compliance violation.

- 5.2. Business Justification
 - The access request ticket must specify the business purpose, the target tables,
and a designated expiration date (no longer than 90 days).
- 5.3. Inactive Revocation
 - Access is automatically revoked after 30 days of inactivity.
- 6. PERSONAL DATA MASKING AND ANONYMIZATION RULES
 - To protect customer privacy, data must be treated as follows:
 - 6.1. Export Anonymization
 - Any extract containing Customer Personally Identifiable Information (PII) must be anonymized, masked, or scrubbed before export.
 - Exporting raw PII to local machines is strictly prohibited unless approved directly by the CDO for urgent legal investigations.
 - 6.2. Masking Standards
 - Emails must be masked (e.g. u***r@company.com), phone numbers replaced with random values, and addresses truncated to ZIP codes.
- 7. ANALYTICAL ROW-LEVEL SECURITY (RLS) RULES
 - To restrict access to financial dashboard information, RLS is mandatory:
 - 7.1. Departmental RLS Implementation
 - All analytical dashboards and reporting schemas containing financial data must implement row-level security based on the user's department.
 - Users may only view rows corresponding to their assigned business department.
- 8. AUDITING AND QUARTERLY ACCESS REVIEWS
 - Permissions must be audited continuously to prevent access bloat:
 - 8.1. Quarterly Reviews
 - A formal quarterly review of all database permissions must be performed by the Data Custodian.
 - Inactive, legacy, or transferred user permissions must be revoked within 24 hours of audit completion.
- 9. PROCEDURAL STEP-BY-STEP FLOW
 - Step 1: Analyst identifies a business need for customer database access.
 - Step 2: Analyst submits a Jira ticket containing detailed justification.
 - Step 3: DBA reviews the ticket, confirms scope, and assigns temporary access.
 - Step 4: CDO signs off on the ticket for production permissions.
 - Step 5: DBA configures access and ensures RLS is active for the user's department.
 - Step 6: Analyst executes queries. If exporting, analyst runs the anonymization utility.
 - Step 7: DBA logs quarterly audit, identifying legacy users.
 - Step 8: Legacy permissions are revoked, and the audit report is signed by CDO.
- 10. TROUBLESHOOTING & ESCALATION PROCEDURES
 - 10.1. Unauthorized Access Alert
 - If an automated alert detects a user querying tables outside their scope without a Jira ticket, access is auto-disabled.
 - 10.2. Escalation Contact Path
 - First Level: Data Custodian (DBA Team).
 - Second Level: Chief Data Officer (Sanjay Mehta).
 - Executive Escalation: VP of Engineering (Sneha Deshmukh / Escalation Lead).

11. REVISION HISTORY LOG

Version	Date	Author	Description of Change
v1.0	2024-02-15	S. Mehta	Initial data access governance SOP.
v2.0	2025-01-20	S. Mehta	Mandated IT Ticketing for all database logs.
v3.0	2026-01-15	S. Mehta	Added strict PII anonymization mandates.